

PathFinder — Deployment Guide

1. Overview

PathFinder is deployed as two separate services:

- **Frontend:** Hosted on **Vercel** (free Hobby tier)
- **Backend:** Hosted on **Render** (free tier)

Both services auto-deploy from the `main` branch of the GitHub repository.

2. Prerequisites

- GitHub account with the PathFinder repository
 - Vercel account (sign up at vercel.com with GitHub)
 - Render account (sign up at render.com with GitHub)
 - All code pushed to the `main` branch
-

3. Backend Deployment (Render)

Step 1: Create a New Web Service

1. Log in to render.com.
2. Click "New" → "Web Service."
3. Connect your GitHub repository (VaibhavJain2906/PathFinder).
4. Select the `main` branch.

Step 2: Configure Build Settings

Setting	Value
Name	PathFinder_Backend
Language	Node
Root Directory	backend
Build Command	<code>npm install && npx prisma generate && npx prisma db push</code>
Start Command	<code>npx tsx index.ts</code>
Instance Type	Free

Step 3: Environment Variables

Add the following environment variables:

Key	Value
DATABASE_URL	<code>file:./dev.db</code>
JWT_SECRET	<code><your-secret-key></code>
PORT	<code>5000</code>
GEMINI_API_KEY	<code><optional-ai-key></code>

Step 4: Deploy

Click "Create Web Service." Render will build and deploy the backend. Wait for the status to show "Live."

Step 5: Copy the URL

Copy the deployed URL (e.g., `https://pathfinder-backend-j111.onrender.com`). You will need this for the frontend deployment.

4. Frontend Deployment (Vercel)

Step 1: Import Repository

1. Log in to vercel.com.
2. Click "Add New" → "Project."
3. Import the PathFinder repository from GitHub.

Step 2: Configure Settings

Setting	Value
Root Directory	frontend
Framework Preset	Vite
Build Command	vite build (override the default to skip tsc)

Step 3: Environment Variables

Key	Value
VITE_API_URL	https://pathfinder-backend-j111.onrender.com

Step 4: Deploy

Click "Deploy." Vercel will build the frontend and provide a public URL.

5. Post-Deployment Checklist

Check	Description	Status
Backend health	Visit <code><backend-url>/api/admin/system-health</code>	Verify JSON response
Frontend loads	Visit the Vercel URL	Landing page renders
Login works	Test login with existing credentials	Token received
API connection	Perform any action requiring API call	No CORS errors
File uploads	Upload a resume or profile picture	File saved and accessible

6. Continuous Deployment

Both Vercel and Render are configured for auto-deployment:

- Any `git push` to the `main` branch triggers a new build on both services.
 - Vercel typically deploys in 30-60 seconds.
 - Render typically deploys in 2-5 minutes.
-

7. Rollback Strategy

Vercel

1. Go to the Vercel dashboard → Deployments tab.
2. Find the previous successful deployment.
3. Click the three-dot menu → "Promote to Production."

Render

1. Go to the Render dashboard → Events tab.
 2. Render automatically rolls back if the build fails.
 3. For manual rollback, push a revert commit to GitHub.
-

8. Important Notes

- **Render Free Tier Cold Starts:** The backend server goes to sleep after 15 minutes of inactivity. The first request after sleep takes approximately 50 seconds.
 - **Database Persistence:** SQLite data persists on Render's ephemeral storage. For production, consider migrating to PostgreSQL.
 - **CORS Configuration:** The backend's CORS settings must include the Vercel frontend URL for production.
-

End of Deployment Guide